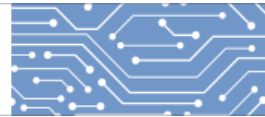


Akamai Technologies Inc. (AKAM): Communacopia + Technology 2026

— Key Takeaways

Communacopia + Technology
September 8–11, 2026 | San Francisco

Explore >



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Bottom Line: Akamai framed the AI compute opportunity as increasingly visible and economically disciplined, with over \$2.8bn of multi-year CIS commitments already signed and growth expected to accelerate from mid-single digits today to teens next year based on signed deals alone. Management emphasized that the gating factor is power/colo rather than demand, and that Akamai is protecting downside through take-or-pay structures, cost escalators, component pass-throughs and a preference to secure 70%-80%+ of capacity with customer deals before committing to colo.

Key Takeaways

- **Compute economics:** Management provided more detail on how Akamai is underwriting the CIS buildout. Large deals typically generate \$0.50–\$1.00 of recurring revenue per \$1 of capex, with operating margins in the mid-20s to mid-30s and payback in roughly 2–3 years. Colo is the biggest near-term P&L risk because expense starts when Akamai gets access to power, so the company is keeping capacity commitments tightly linked to signed demand and building in contract protection for labor, colo and component inflation.
- **Pipeline:** Akamai described the compute pipeline as larger than anything it has seen historically, with demand extending into 2028. The company expects announced deals to begin contributing in 4Q and ramp through 2027, with incremental deals now more likely to add late-2027 and 2028 revenue. Management also noted that the pipeline is mostly CPU, not just GPU, as AI systems require substantial CPU and storage around the GPU layer.
- **Security:** AI is also creating a stronger top-of-funnel for security, with CISOs reassessing whether mature products like WAF, bot management and segmentation are deployed broadly enough. Akamai expects this to support demand across both core security and newer assets, including LayerX for

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browser/data-loss use cases and Noname/API security as agentic applications create more machine-to-machine traffic.

Valuation/Risks

We remain Sell rated with a 12-month price target of \$93 based on 26x our forward Q5-Q8 FCF estimates.

Upside risks include: more visibility into the durability of sustaining >10% Security growth through 2027, improving capex efficiency in the Compute business, material upside from inference cloud opportunity.

AKAM	12m Price Target: \$93.00	Price: \$106.79	Downside: 12.9%
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Sell		GS Forecast			
Market cap: \$15.7bn Enterprise value: \$20.5bn 3m ADTV: \$415.6mn United States Americas Software M&A Rank: 3	Revenue (\$ mn)	12/25	12/26E	12/27E	12/28E
	EBITDA (\$ mn)	4,208.2	4,473.7	4,946.9	5,349.0
	EBIT (\$ mn)	1,801.6	1,761.5	2,046.3	2,275.1
	EPS (\$)	1,253.6	1,144.2	1,226.4	1,432.3
	P/E (X)	7.12	6.77	7.11	8.16
	EV/EBITDA (X)	11.5	15.8	15.0	13.1
	FCF yield (%)	8.3	11.5	9.9	8.9
	Dividend yield (%)	(2.2)	(14.8)	2.4	4.7
	Net debt/EBITDA (X)	—	—	—	—
		1.6	2.8	2.5	2.1
	EPS (\$)	6/26	9/26E	12/26E	3/27E
		1.59	1.70	1.83	1.74

Source: Company data, Goldman Sachs Research estimates, FactSet. Price as of 11 Sep 2026 close.

Disclosure Appendix

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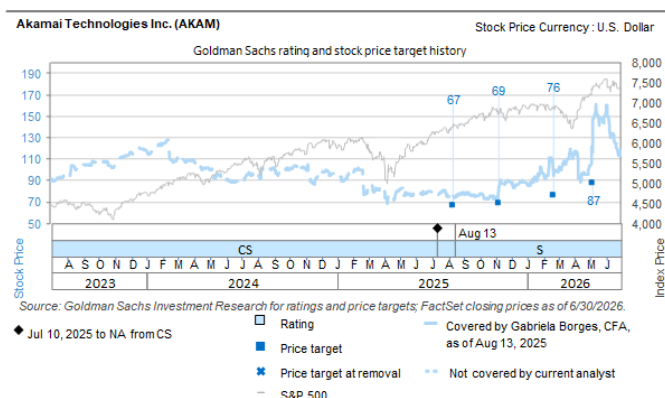
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Target price history table(s)

Akamai Technologies Inc. (AKAM)

Date of report	Target price (\$)	Closing price (\$)
07-Aug-26	93.00	110.54
08-May-26	87.00	147.71
20-Feb-26	76.00	94.17
07-Nov-25	69.00	83.74
13-Aug-25	67.00	75.44

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